

PMBOK / PMI | PMB-12

Activity and Milestone List

The activities required to produce the deliverables, with attributes and milestones

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Activity and Milestone List
Document reference	PMB-12-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Project manager with work package owners
Approver	Not applicable — an input to the schedule
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
PMB-10	Work Breakdown Structure and WBS Dictionary	Activities decompose from work packages
PMB-13	Schedule Baseline and Network	Activities are sequenced into the schedule
PMB-18	Resource Management Plan	Resource requirements per activity

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Lists all schedule activities decomposed from work packages, with their attributes, and separately lists the milestones — significant points with zero duration — including those imposed by contract or regulation.
Framework	PMBOK / PMI — Schedule Management — Define Activities
Created when	During planning, after the WBS
Reviewed / updated	At each rolling wave planning cycle
Owner	Project manager with work package owners
Approver	Not applicable — an input to the schedule
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	Distinguish mandatory milestones (contract, regulatory, external) from those the project has chosen. Only the first constrain the schedule absolutely.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- Every activity traces to a WBS work package
- Activities are stated as verbs — a noun is a deliverable, not an activity
- Milestones have zero duration and are verifiable events
- Mandatory and discretionary milestones are distinguished
- Resource requirements and skill needs are captured per activity

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1. Activity list

Activity ID	Activity	WBS code	Description	Predecessors	Successors	Effort	Duration	Resource type	Owner	Constraints
A-010	Complete hall B structural survey	2.3	Complete hall B structural survey	—	A-020	120 h	15 d	Structural engineer	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	Capital released tranche by tranche at gate approval only
A-020	Place structural strengthening order	2.3	Place structural strengthening order	A-010	A-030	40 h	10 d	Procurement	E. Santos, Procurement Lead	No production change during the Group financial close window
A-030	Execute floor strengthening works	2.3	Execute floor strengthening works	A-020	A-110	400 h	45 d	M&E contractor	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	Restricted training data must

Activity ID	Activity	WBS code	Description	Predecessors	Successors	Effort	Duration	Resource type	Owner	Constraints
										remain within UAE borders
A-040	Lodge utility uplift application	2.1	Lodge utility uplift application	—	A-050	60 h	10 d	Facilities	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	Grid capacity at DXB-1 is capped at 6.2 MVA until 2028
A-050	Install switchgear and energise 6 MVA supply	2.1	Install switchgear and energise 6 MVA supply	A-040	A-110	580 h	90 d	Utility and M&E	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	Floor loading in hall B limited to 1,400 kg per rack position
A-060	Install CDUs and secondary cooling loop	2.2	Install CDUs and secondary cooling loop	A-030	A-110	760 h	40 d	M&E contractor	A. Kowalski, Data	Capital release

Activity ID	Activity	WBS code	Description	Predecessors	Successors	Effort	Duration	Resource type	Owner	Constraints
									Centre Lead	ed tranche by tranche at gate approval only
A-070	Build leaf-spine fabric in hall A	4.1	Build leaf-spine fabric in hall A	—	A-080	640 h	30 d	Network engineers	J. Ferreira, Network Lead	No production change during the Group financial close window
A-080	Tune congestion control and benchmark NCCL	4.2	Tune congestion control and benchmark NCCL	A-070	A-120	380 h	20 d	Network and vendor	J. Ferreira, Network Lead	Restricted training data must remain within UAE

Activity ID	Activity	WBS code	Description	Predecessors	Successors	Effort	Duration	Resource type	Owner	Const raints
										borde rs
A-090	Receive and firmware-verify accelerator shipment	3.1	Receive and firmware-verify accelerator shipment	—	A-100	260 h	12 d	Infrastructur e and security	K. Adeyemi, Security Architect	Grid capac ity at DXB-1 is cappe d at 6.2 MVA until 2028
A-100	Rack, cable and burn-in accelerators	3.1	Rack, cable and burn-in accelerators	A-090	A-110	1,220 h	35 d	Infrastructur e engineers	S. Bhatt, Project Manager	Floor loadi ng in hall B limite d to 1,400 kg per rack positi on

2. Milestone list

Ref	Milestone	Type	Target date	Verification	Owner	Source of constraint
MS-01	Programme mandate approved and	Mandatory /	12 Mar 2026	Acceptance certificate signed by	R. Al Mazrouei,	e.g. Regulatory deadline

Ref	Milestone	Type	Target date	Verification	Owner	Source of constraint
	<i>funding released for Tranche 1</i>	Discretionary		<i>the Programme Manager</i>	Group CTO	
MS-02	<i>Pilot cluster of 256 GPUs live in DXB-1 hall A</i>	Delivery	28 Aug 2026	<i>Acceptance certificate signed by the Programme Manager</i>	S. Bhatt, Project Manager	Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate
MS-03	<i>Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review and Tranche 2 funding gate</i>	Gate	18 Sep 2026	<i>Acceptance certificate signed by the Programme Manager</i>	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Configuration management database
MS-04	<i>Hall B structural strengthening complete</i>	Delivery	15 Dec 2026	<i>Acceptance certificate signed by the Programme Manager</i>	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	Programme SharePoint — Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance
MS-05	<i>Utility uplift to 6 MVA energised</i>	External	30 Nov 2026	<i>Acceptance certificate signed by the Programme Manager</i>	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space
MS-06	<i>Hall A scaled to 1,024 GPUs and accepted</i>	Delivery	26 Feb 2027	<i>Acceptance certificate signed by the Programme Manager</i>	S. Bhatt, Project Manager	ALM tool — Helios ART board
MS-07	<i>Platform v1.0 released — scheduling, quota, observability, image supply chain</i>	Delivery	31 Mar 2027	<i>Acceptance certificate signed by the Programme Manager</i>	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate
MS-08	<i>Independent security assurance and penetration test passed</i>	Assurance	23 Apr 2027	<i>Acceptance certificate signed by the Programme Manager</i>	L. Haddad, CISO	Configuration management database
MS-09	<i>Multi-tenant go-live with three business units onboarded</i>	Delivery	28 May 2027	<i>Acceptance certificate signed by the Programme Manager</i>	V. Chandra, Head of AI Enablement	Programme SharePoint — Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance
MS-10	<i>Hall B scaled to 2,048 GPUs total and accepted</i>	Delivery	25 Jun 2027	<i>Acceptance certificate signed by the Programme Manager</i>	S. Bhatt, Project Manager	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space
MS-11	<i>Tranche 2 end-of-tranche review and Tranche 3 funding gate</i>	Gate	16 Jul 2027	<i>Acceptance certificate signed by the Programme Manager</i>	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space

3. Activity attributes — assumptions and leads/lags

Activity ID	Assumption or lead/lag	Rationale	Impact if wrong
Tune congestion control and benchmark NCCL	Vendor GPU allocation of 2,048 units for Tranche 2 will be honoured at the quoted delivery dates	Supply chain provenance for AI tooling is weak; admission control is the only enforceable point	Tranche 2 completion slips by at least one quarter and contract terms are renegotiated
Build leaf-spine fabric in hall A	DXB-1 has 6 MVA of usable capacity available to the programme without a utility upgrade	Two independent schedulers fragment the GPU pool and reduce effective capacity	Tranche 2 capped at 1,024 GPUs and the AUH-2 site is brought forward two quarters
Install CDUs and secondary cooling loop	Three business units will migrate committed workloads within six months of hall A handover	Supply chain provenance for AI tooling is weak; admission control is the only enforceable point	Utilisation benefit of AED 14.2m over five years is not realised in full
Install switchgear and energise 6 MVA supply	Training data classified as Restricted must remain within UAE borders at rest and in transit	Grid capacity at DXB-1 supports Tranche 2 in full, so a second site is not yet justified	Not applicable — this is a fixed constraint on design
Lodge utility uplift application	Liquid cooling maintenance can be absorbed by the existing facilities contract without an uplift	Air cooling would cap density at 12 kW per rack and require 2.4 times the floor area	Annual run cost increases by approximately AED 780,000
Execute floor strengthening works	No production change may be made during the Group financial close window, the last five working days of each quarter	Consolidation is the primary source of the benefit case; utilisation across siloed estates averages 31%	Not applicable — planned into the release calendar
Place structural strengthening order	The existing 400G core has spare port capacity for four additional leaf pairs	Physical lead times do not tolerate emerging requirements, so this element is frozen before order	Additional AED 2.1m of core switching required and eight weeks of lead time added

4. Rolling wave status

Which parts of the plan are decomposed to activity level and which remain at work package level.

WBS area	Detail level	Decompose by	Owner
DXB-1 halls A and B, 2,048 accelerators and the	Delegated to the Programme Manager	Reflected in the solution intent as a	K. Adeyemi, Security Architect

WBS area	Detail level	Decompose by	Owner
<i>supporting fabric and storage</i>	<i>within tolerance; above tolerance to the Programme Board</i>	<i>fixed constraint</i>	
<i>Platform, MLOps and security workstreams across the Agile Release Train</i>	<i>Reviewed at each end-of-tranche review and updated by change control only</i>	<i>Scoped to the three onboarding tenants: AI Research, Fraud Analytics and Retail</i>	<i>D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager</i>
<i>Facilities, power and cooling works within the Tranche 2 boundary</i>	<i>Enforced automatically in the pipeline; manual assertion is not accepted as evidence</i>	<i>Assured independently by Cordant Assurance</i>	<i>F. Mansour, Business Change Lead</i>
<i>Excludes AUH-2, model development and business-unit data engineering</i>	<i>Any deviation requires a recorded waiver accepted by the CISO with a stated expiry</i>	<i>Reviewed monthly at the Programme Board</i>	<i>T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect</i>